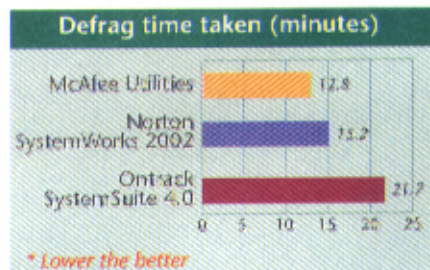


SCORE BOARD



	McAfee Utilities	Norton SystemWorks 2002	Ontrack SystemSuite 4.0
Features			
Security			
Virus protection	VirusScan	Norton AntiVirus	VirusScanner Pro
Firewall	✗	✗	NetDefense Firewall
Permanent data erasing	McAfee Shredder	✗	DataEraser
Maintenance			
Disk defragmentation	McAfee Disk Tune	Speed Disk	JETDefrag
Scandisk	DiskMinder	Norton Disk Doctor	DiskFixer
Registry cleaning	✓	✓	RegistryCleaner
Registry repair	✓	Quick Fix	RegistryFixer
Registry backup & restore	✓	✓	✗
Registry optimising	✓	✓	RegistryDefrag
Uninstall utility	✗	Norton CleanSweep	Uninstall
Automatic data backup utility	✓	Backup Wizard	System File Backup
Zip/Unzip utility	Zip Manager	✗	Zip
File manager	✗	✗	PowerDesk 4 Pro
Recovery			
Format recovery	✗	NA	EasyRecovery
Recover data from virus attack	✗	GoBack 3	EasyRecovery
Hard drive crash recovery	✗	GoBack 3	EasyRecovery
Utility for restoring deleted files	✓	✓	EasyRecovery
Crash protection	Crash Protector	✗	CrashProof
System restore	✗	GoBack 3	SystemSaver
Bootable rescue disk	✓	Bootable CD	Bootable CD
Compatibility & Support			
Help and documentation (Scale of 5)	4	5	5
Online help	✓	✓	✓
FAQs	✓	✓	✓
Online chat	✓	✗	✗
OS supported	Windows 95/98/Me	Windows 98/Me/NT/2000/XP	Windows 95/98/2000/XP
Ease of Use			
Use of self explanatory icons (Scale of 5)	4	4	5
Ease of menu navigation (Scale of 5)	3	4	4
Quality of Wizards used (Scale of 5)	4	5	5
Customisable toolbar	✗	✗	✓
Performance			
File recovery (Scale of 5)	3	5	3
Format recovery (Scale of 5)	0	5	5
Defrag.time	12 min 48 sec	21 min 39 sec	15 min 9 sec
Decrease in Registry size	Nil	NA*	0.14 MB
CPU Load	6%	8%	11%
Memory utilisation	3.4 MB	19.1 MB	51.1 MB
Increase in bootup time	4.6 sec	14.63 sec	9.62 sec
Overall Score			
Features (40%)	22.8	27	37
Ease of use (10%)	6	7	9.6
Performance (30%)	15.2	20.4	19.6
Value for money (20%)	15.58	7.02	16.78
Overall rating	59.58	61.42	82.98
Overall grade	D	B	A
Vendor name	Network Associates	Tech Pacific	Ontrack
Phone	NA	022-5960238	NA
E-mail	custserv_APAC@nai.com	jitenrag@techpac.com	sales@ontrack.com
Web site	www.mcafee-at-home.com	www.norton.com	www.ontrack.com
Price (Rs)	1,950	5,400	2,698



Data loss is the most serious fallout of a hard disk crash. Coming in a close second is the anxiety caused by an accidentally deleted file or, heaven forbid, an entire disk partition. This happens due to the fact that Windows, by default, does not have any data recovery tool and the special tools that advertise data recovery are often out of the reach of most of us. Therefore, a data recovery utility bundled with a system suite is a blessing. When it came to recovering deleted files, the Norton suite ruled the roost. It recovered every file emptied from the Recycle Bin during our tests. Ontrack and McAfee did fairly well, successfully restoring three of the five files deleted. We formatted an entire partition to evaluate data recovery in this case and were able to recover every bit of information from the deleted partition using both the Norton and the Ontrack suites. McAfee did not have this feature at all.

An auto-backup utility is a neat and hands-off way to back up critical data at regular intervals of time. The Ontrack suite comes with the System File Backup tool that backs up only critical system files and therefore doesn't qualify as a full-fledged backup utility. Norton Backup Wizard goes one step ahead of the pack—it archives infrequently used programs and compresses them. These can then be shifted to another computer, saving valuable hard disk space. McAfee Quick Copy, on the other hand, moves or copies the data (files, folders, etc) to any specified location either on a local drive or another computer on the network. However, there's no automatic scheduling feature, making its efficiency subject to the frequency with which the update is carried out.

What it all leads to

If you share your system with others or if you store mission-critical data on your computer, it makes sense to invest some money and allot a few resources for a system suite—they offer to keep your system as good as new and free from viruses and



* Does not allow multiple selection of stray registry entries